Chapter 6 — UI State Modeling & Unidirectional Data Flow

> **Part I — Core Infrastructure** · Complexity: **Complex** (≥40 interview questions)
>
> **Prerequisites:** Ch 1 (`Outcome` / `AppError`), Ch 3 (`Resource<T>` , SSOT), Ch 5 (Hilt/ `@HiltViewModel`). This chapter **defines** the UI-state and UDF conventions (`UiState` , `UiEvent` , `StateFlow` , `stateIn` / `WhileSubscribed` , one-time events preview) that every feature ViewModel in the book follows — Ch 7 deepens events, Ch 8 adds process-death restoration, Ch 9 applies it to search.
>
> **Reference surface in StreamCart:** the presentation layer of every feature — we use the Cart screen as the running example.

6.1 Problem Definition and Real-World Context

The UI layer's job is to render *state* and forward *events*. It sounds simple, yet it's where most Android bugs live: inconsistent screens, lost state on rotation, flicker, double-submits, and "impossible" UI combinations (a spinner and an error and data all at once). The root cause is almost always an **unprincipled state model** and **bidirectional data flow**.

Naive approaches fail because:

- **Scattered mutable fields.** `isLoading` , `error` , `items` , `isEmpty` as separate `MutableState` s let the UI reach illegal combinations (loading *and* error) and force every composable to re-derive what to show.
- **Views mutating state directly.** When a composable flips a flag and the ViewModel flips another, there's no single place that defines "what the screen shows," so two screens or two code paths disagree.
- **State owned by the View.** Holding state in composables/Fragments loses it on rotation and process death and makes it untestable.
- **One-time events modeled as state.** Showing a snackbar or navigating by setting a boolean causes the event to re-fire on rotation (the snackbar reappears).

Unidirectional Data Flow (UDF) fixes this: state flows *down* from a single owner (the ViewModel's `StateFlow<UiState>`) to the UI; events flow *up* from the UI to the ViewModel. State is modeled explicitly so illegal combinations are unrepresentable. This is the backbone pattern for every screen in the book.

Three practical use cases

1. **E-commerce cart (StreamCart Shop).** One `CartUiState` drives item list, totals, loading, and error; quantity changes are events; the screen can't show a stale total.
2. **OTT detail screen (StreamCart Watch).** Content metadata, "in my list" toggle, and download state are one cohesive state; actions are events; it survives rotation.

3. **Social feed (StreamCart Social).** Infinite list + refresh + per-item optimistic likes modeled as state; a like tap is an event handled by the ViewModel (Ch 72).

Why this is architectural

UDF decides **who owns state**, **how the UI observes it**, **how events are dispatched**, and **what states are even possible**. These determine testability, lifecycle-safety, and whether screens stay consistent — system-level concerns, not view code.

6.2 Requirements Engineering

Functional requirements

ID	Requirement
F1	The screen renders from a single `UiState` exposed by the ViewModel.
F2	The UI sends user intents as `UiEvent`s to the ViewModel; it never mutates business state.
F3	Illegal state combinations are unrepresentable by construction.
F4	State survives configuration changes (rotation).
F5	One-time effects (snackbar, navigation) fire exactly once, not on rotation.
F6	State collection is lifecycle-aware (stops when the UI is not visible).
F7	The ViewModel is unit-testable without Android/UI.

Non-functional requirements

Attribute	Policy
Correctness	Exhaustive `when` over state; no impossible combinations.
Performance	Minimal recomposition; conflated state; stable types.
Memory	`viewModelScope` bounds work; `WhileSubscribed` stops idle pipelines.
Testability	Pure state logic; injected dispatchers (Ch 5).
Maintainability	One state model per screen; consistent naming.

Scope

- **In scope:** `UiState` modeling (sealed vs single-immutable), UDF loop, `StateFlow` / `stateIn`, event handling, one-time effects (intro), lifecycle-aware collection, MVVM-with-UDF vs MVI.
- **Out of scope:** one-time events deep dive (Ch 7), process-death persistence (Ch 8), debounced input (Ch 9), navigation architecture (Ch 53).

Assumptions & constraints

- Jetpack Compose, `StateFlow`, `@HiltViewModel`, coroutines. `minSdk 24`.

6.3 System Design Fundamentals

- **Unidirectional Data Flow.** State down, events up. The ViewModel is the only state owner; the UI is a pure function of state.
- **Single immutable state object.** The screen's state is one immutable value (`data class` or `sealed interface`), so a render is a snapshot — no partial updates, no torn reads.
- **Make illegal states unrepresentable.** Model mutually-exclusive conditions as a sealed hierarchy (Loading / Content / Error) rather than independent booleans.
- **`StateFlow` as the holder.** Conflated, always-has-a-value, hot — ideal for UI state. The UI collects it lifecycle-aware.
- **Events vs state.** Durable screen conditions are *state*; things that happen once (navigate, toast) are *effects/events* (Ch 7) and must not live in state.
- **`stateIn` + `WhileSubscribed`.** Convert a cold pipeline into UI state that starts on subscription, stops shortly after the UI leaves, and replays the last value on return.
- **Reducer (MVI).** Optionally, a pure `(state, event) -> state` function centralizes transitions, maximizing testability.

Core insight: **model the screen as one explicit, immutable state owned by the ViewModel, and treat the UI as `render(state)`.** Everything else — consistency, rotation-safety, testability — follows.

6.4 High-Level Architecture


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Components & ownership

- **`CartScreen`** is stateless: it receives `CartUiState` and emits events; it holds no business state.
- **`CartViewModel`** owns `uiState` (the single source for the screen) and a one-time `effects` channel (Ch 7). It turns events into use-case calls and maps results/`Resource` into state.
- **Domain/Data** provide the actual data via the SSOT repository (Ch 3).

Data direction: state flows down (`StateFlow` → UI); events flow up (UI → ViewModel). The UI never writes business state; the ViewModel never touches Views.

6.5 Detailed Component Design

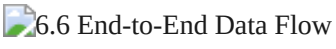

6.5 Detailed Component Design

Element	Responsibility	Notes
`CartUiState`	everything the screen needs to render	sealed; exhaustive `when`
`CartUiEvent`	user intents	sealed; one entry point `onEvent`
`CartEffect`	one-time effects (nav, snackbar)	via `Channel` (Ch 7)
`CartViewModel`	own state, handle events, map data	`viewModelScope`, injected dispatchers

Two valid state-modeling styles

- **Single immutable `data class`** with a nested status — good when parts of the screen are always present (e.g., a toolbar) alongside a loading/error body.
- **Sealed hierarchy** (Loading/Content/Empty/Error) — good when the whole screen is in exactly one mode. The Cart uses a sealed hierarchy; the `Content` state carries a `mutating` flag for in-place updates (e.g., changing quantity) so we don't drop back to a full-screen spinner.

6.6 End-to-End Data Flow


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6.7 Complete Kotlin Implementation

Package: `com.streamcart.cart`.

6.7.1 State, events, effects

```
sealed interface CartUiState {
    data object Loading : CartUiState
    data object Empty : CartUiState
    data class Content(
        val lines: List<CartLine>,
        val total: Money,
        val mutating: Boolean = false,     // in-place update without full spinner
    ) : CartUiState
    data class Error(val error: AppError) : CartUiState
}

sealed interface CartUiEvent {
    data class IncrementQty(val lineId: String) : CartUiEvent
    data class DecrementQty(val lineId: String) : CartUiEvent
    data class Remove(val lineId: String) : CartUiEvent
    data object Checkout : CartUiEvent
    data object Retry : CartUiEvent
}

sealed interface CartEffect {                  // one-time (Ch 7)
    data class ShowSnackbar(val message: String) : CartEffect
    data object NavigateToCheckout : CartEffect
}
```

6.7.2 ViewModel (state owner, UDF loop)

```
@HiltViewModel
class CartViewModel @Inject constructor(
    private val observeCart: ObserveCartUseCase,
    private val updateQuantity: UpdateQuantityUseCase,
    private val removeLine: RemoveLineUseCase,
) : ViewModel() {

    private val _effects = Channel<CartEffect>(Channel.BUFFERED)
    val effects: Flow<CartEffect> = _effects.receiveAsFlow()

    val uiState: StateFlow<CartUiState> =
        observeCart()                                        // Flow<Resource<Cart>> (Ch 3)
            .map { it.toUiState() }
            .catch { emit(CartUiState.Error(it.toAppError())) }
            .stateIn(
                scope = viewModelScope,
                started = SharingStarted.WhileSubscribed(5_000),
                initialValue = CartUiState.Loading,
            )

    fun onEvent(event: CartUiEvent) {
        when (event) {
            is CartUiEvent.IncrementQty -> changeQty(event.lineId, +1)
            is CartUiEvent.DecrementQty -> changeQty(event.lineId, -1)
            is CartUiEvent.Remove -> viewModelScope.launch {
                if (removeLine(event.lineId) is Outcome.Failure)
                    _effects.send(CartEffect.ShowSnackbar("Couldn't remove item"))
            }
            CartUiEvent.Checkout -> viewModelScope.launch {
                _effects.send(CartEffect.NavigateToCheckout)
            }
            CartUiEvent.Retry -> { /* re-subscribe handled by upstream; or trigger refresh */ }
        }
    }

    private fun changeQty(lineId: String, delta: Int) = viewModelScope.launch {
        when (updateQuantity(lineId, delta)) {               // SSOT write updates Flow
            is Outcome.Failure -> _effects.send(CartEffect.ShowSnackbar("Couldn't update
quantity"))
            is Outcome.Success -> Unit                        // Flow re-emits new Content
        }
    }
```

```
    private fun Resource<Cart>.toUiState(): CartUiState = when (this) {
        is Resource.Loading -> data?.toContent() ?: CartUiState.Loading
        is Resource.Success -> data.toContent()
        is Resource.Error -> data?.toContent() ?: CartUiState.Error(error)
    }

    private fun Cart.toContent(): CartUiState =
        if (lines.isEmpty()) CartUiState.Empty
        else CartUiState.Content(lines, total)
}
```

> Because the cart is backed by the SSOT (Ch 3), a quantity write updates Room, whose `Flow` re-emits — the ViewModel does **not** manually mutate the list. State stays derived from the single source of truth.

6.7.3 Compose UI (stateless render + effects)

```
@Composable
fun CartRoute(
    viewModel: CartViewModel = hiltViewModel(),
    onNavigateToCheckout: () -> Unit,
    snackbarHostState: SnackbarHostState,
) {
    val state by viewModel.uiState.collectAsStateWithLifecycle()

    // One-time effects: collected lifecycle-aware, fired once (Ch 7).
    LaunchedEffect(Unit) {
        viewModel.effects.flowWithLifecycle(/* lifecycle */).collect { effect ->
            when (effect) {
                is CartEffect.ShowSnackbar -> snackbarHostState.showSnackbar(effect.message)
                CartEffect.NavigateToCheckout -> onNavigateToCheckout()
            }
        }
    }

    CartScreen(state = state, onEvent = viewModel::onEvent)
}

@Composable
fun CartScreen(state: CartUiState, onEvent: (CartUiEvent) -> Unit) {
    when (state) {                                    // exhaustive — compiler-enforced
        CartUiState.Loading -> FullScreenSpinner()
        CartUiState.Empty -> EmptyCart()
        is CartUiState.Error -> ErrorPane(state.error, onRetry = { onEvent(CartUiEvent.Retry) })
        is CartUiState.Content -> CartContent(
            lines = state.lines,
            total = state.total,
            mutating = state.mutating,
            onEvent = onEvent,
        )
    }
}
```

6.7.4 Optional: an explicit reducer (MVI style)

```
// When transitions are complex, centralize them as a pure function (easy to test).
fun cartReducer(state: CartUiState, event: CartUiEvent): CartUiState = when (event) {
    is CartUiEvent.IncrementQty ->
        (state as? CartUiState.Content)?.copy(mutating = true) ?: state
    // ... other transitions
    else -> state
}
```

6.7.5 Module structure

```
:feature:cart
  ui/           CartRoute, CartScreen, CartContent, EmptyCart, ErrorPane, previews
  presentation/ CartViewModel, CartUiState, CartUiEvent, CartEffect, cartReducer
:domain/usecase ObserveCartUseCase, UpdateQuantityUseCase, RemoveLineUseCase
:data:cart      CartRepository (SSOT, Ch 3)
```

6.8 Concurrency and Race Conditions

Scenario	Risk	Handling
Rapid events (double-tap +)	Duplicate writes / flicker	SSOT write is idempotent per state; `mutating` flag; debounce if needed (Ch 9)
Multiple collectors of `uiState`	Divergent UI	`StateFlow` shares one value; all collectors see the same
Event handling races state emission	Torn UI	State is immutable snapshots; emissions are serialized by `StateFlow`
Effect lost if UI not collecting	Missed snackbar/nav	`Channel` buffers; collected lifecycle-aware (Ch 7)
Rotation during in-flight update	Lost work / double work	`viewModelScope` survives config change; `WhileSubscribed` replays last state

- **State emissions are serialized** by `StateFlow`, and each emission is an immutable value — there is no partial/torn UI state.
- **One entry point (`onEvent`)** serializes intent handling conceptually; use a `Channel`/actor if strict ordering of side effects is required.

6.9 Failure Scenarios and Recovery

Failure	Detection	Response	UX	Telemetry
Data load error	`Resource.Error`	`Error` state (or keep `Content` with cached data)	error pane + Retry	`screen_error{screen=cart}`
Action (write) fails	`Outcome.Failure`	roll back optimistic change; emit snackbar effect	toast, state unchanged	`action_error{event}`
Rotation	—	`viewModelScope` + `WhileSubscribed`	seamless, no refetch	—
Process death	—	restore via `SavedStateHandle` (Ch 8)	seamless	—
Effect delivered while backgrounded	lifecycle STOPPED	`Channel` buffers; delivered on resume	no lost nav/snackbar	—
Illegal state attempted	—	unrepresentable by type	n/a (compile-time)	—



> **Optimistic UX pattern (preview of Ch 72):** flip the UI immediately (`mutating` /optimistic value), then confirm or roll back on the result. UDF makes rollback trivial — just emit the previous state.

6.10 Scaling the Implementation

- **Level 1.** One `data class` state, a few events, `onEvent`.
- **Level 2.** Sealed state hierarchy; one-time effects via `Channel`; previews per state.
- **Level 3 — production.** State derived from SSOT (`Resource`), lifecycle-aware collection, `SavedStateHandle` (Ch 8), optimistic updates with rollback.
- **Level 4 — large.** Explicit MVI reducer + unit-tested transitions; a shared `BaseViewModel` / `MVIViewModel` contract across features; `combine` of multiple flows into one state; Molecule/compose-state where appropriate.
- **Level 5 — enterprise.** A standardized UDF framework module used by many teams (state/event/effect contracts, testing harness, lint), analytics on state transitions, and design-system-driven state-to-UI mapping.

Avoid overengineering: a static screen with no async doesn't need MVI ceremony — a plain `data class` state is enough. Add a reducer only when transitions get genuinely complex.

6.11 Alternative Approaches and Trade-offs

Dimension	Option A	Option B	When
State holder	`StateFlow`	`LiveData`	`StateFlow` (operators, conflation, KMP, Compose-native); LiveData only in legacy View code
State shape	Sealed hierarchy	Single `data class` + status	Sealed when screen is in one mode; data class when persistent parts coexist with a loading body
Pattern	MVVM + UDF	MVI (reducer)	MVVM+UDF for most screens; MVI when transitions are complex/benefit from a pure reducer
Events	`Channel` (Ch 7)	`SharedFlow`	`Channel` for exactly-once consumer; `SharedFlow` for multiple/replay — see Ch 7
Collection	`collectAsStateWithLifecycle`	`collectAsState`	Lifecycle-aware default; plain only when always-visible
State creation	`stateIn(WhileSubscribed)`	eager `MutableStateFlow`	`stateIn` for derived-from-flow; MutableStateFlow for imperative updates

MVVM+UDF vs MVI: both are unidirectional. MVI formalizes a single `intent` channel and a pure `reduce(state, intent)`; it maximizes testability and traceability at the cost of boilerplate. MVVM+UDF (ViewModel exposes `StateFlow`

- `onEvent`) is lighter and sufficient for most screens. The book uses MVVM+UDF by default and reaches for a reducer when transitions warrant it.

6.12 Security Considerations

- **Don't put secrets in UI state** — state is held in memory, may be logged in crash reports, and (if persisted via `SavedStateHandle`) written to disk. Keep tokens/PII out of `UiState`; reference by id and resolve securely (Ch 20).
- **Redact state in logs/crash breadcrumbs** — logging a `Content` with full PII leaks it (Ch 28); log the state *type* and counts.
- **Effects that navigate** must validate deep-link/args server-side where they grant access; a client-side nav event is not authorization (Ch 52).
- Client vs backend: UI state reflects the client's view; entitlements shown in state must be re-validated by the backend before any privileged action.

6.13 Performance and Resource Optimization

- **Minimize recomposition:** emit *distinct* immutable states; use `@Stable` / `@Immutable` data classes; key lists; hoist state; pass `onEvent: (Event)->Unit` (stable) rather than per-item lambdas where possible.
- **Conflation:** `StateFlow` drops intermediate values — the UI never processes a backlog of loading states.
- **`WhileSubscribed(5000)`:** stop upstream work when the screen is gone; the 5 s window avoids restart churn on rotation.
- **Avoid giant state:** large lists belong in Paging (Ch 13), not a single in-memory `Content`.
- **Profiling:** Layout Inspector recomposition counts, `Recomposition` metrics, Compose compiler reports for unstable params.

6.14 Testing Strategy

The whole point of UDF: the ViewModel is pure-ish and testable with a `TestDispatcher` and fakes — no UI needed.

```
@OptIn(ExperimentalCoroutinesApi::class)
class CartViewModelTest {
    private val dispatcher = StandardTestDispatcher()
    @Before fun setUp() { Dispatchers.setMain(dispatcher) }
    @After fun tearDown() { Dispatchers.resetMain() }

    @Test fun `empty cart maps to Empty state`() = runTest(dispatcher) {
        val vm = CartViewModel(FakeObserveCart(empty = true), FakeUpdateQty(), FakeRemove())
        vm.uiState.test {
            assertEquals(CartUiState.Loading, awaitItem())
            assertEquals(CartUiState.Empty, awaitItem())
            cancelAndIgnoreRemainingEvents()
        }
    }

    @Test fun `failed quantity update emits snackbar effect and keeps state`() =
runTest(dispatcher) {
        val vm = CartViewModel(FakeObserveCart(oneItem = true), FakeUpdateQty(fails = true),
FakeRemove())
        vm.uiState.test {
            awaitItem(); val content = awaitItem() as CartUiState.Content
            vm.effects.test {
                vm.onEvent(CartUiEvent.IncrementQty(content.lines.first().id))
                assertTrue(awaitItem() is CartEffect.ShowSnackbar)
            }
            cancelAndIgnoreRemainingEvents()
        }
    }

    @Test fun `checkout event emits navigation effect`() = runTest(dispatcher) {
        val vm = CartViewModel(FakeObserveCart(oneItem = true), FakeUpdateQty(), FakeRemove())
        vm.effects.test {
            vm.onEvent(CartUiEvent.Checkout)
            assertEquals(CartEffect.NavigateToCheckout, awaitItem())
        }
    }
}

// Pure reducer test (MVI) — no coroutines needed.
@Test fun `increment sets mutating true on Content`() {
    val s = CartUiState.Content(lines, total)
    assertTrue((cartReducer(s, CartUiEvent.IncrementQty("1")) as CartUiState.Content).mutating)
}
```

Also: a Compose UI test asserting each state renders the right node; a recomposition test for stability. Fake use cases/repos; keep the reducer pure.

6.15 Production Observability

- **State/transition analytics:** log state *type* changes (`cart_state{from,to}`) and event frequencies — never raw state contents (PII, Ch 28).
- **Metrics:** error-state rate per screen, time-in-loading (p95), action failure rate, recomposition counts (debug), rotation-survival (should be 100%).
- **Crash breadcrumbs:** include the current `UiState` *type* so a crash report shows what the user was seeing (e.g., "crashed in Cart.Error").
- **Debugging:** snackbar reappears on rotation → effect modeled as state (fix: move to `Channel`, Ch 7); screen blanks on rotation → state owned by View not ViewModel; flicker on every keystroke → state not distinct / Flow rebuilt.

6.16 System Design Interview Preparation

> 40+ questions.

Fundamentals

1. *What is UDF?* State flows down from one owner; events flow up; UI is a pure function of state.
2. *Why a single immutable state object?* Snapshots, no torn/partial UI, easy diffing and testing.
3. *"Make illegal states unrepresentable" — how?* Sealed hierarchy for mutually exclusive modes instead of independent booleans.
4. *State vs event?* Durable conditions are state; one-time occurrences (nav, toast) are effects (Ch 7).
5. *Why `StateFlow` for UI state?* Conflated, always-valued, hot, operator-rich, Compose-native.

Architecture

6. *Who owns screen state?* The ViewModel; the UI is stateless.
7. *Where does the debounce/business logic go?* ViewModel/use cases, not the UI.
8. *How do two screens stay consistent?* Derive state from the SSOT (Ch 3); both observe the same source.
9. *MVVM+UDF vs MVI?* Both unidirectional; MVI adds a pure reducer + single intent channel (more testable, more boilerplate).

Kotlin/Compose

10. *`collectAsState` vs `collectAsStateWithLifecycle`?* The latter stops in STOPPED — correct default.
11. *What does `stateIn(WhileSubscribed(5000))` do?* Starts on subscription, stops 5 s after the last collector, replays last value — rotation-friendly.
12. *Why `data class` + `copy` for updates?* Immutable transitions; previous state retained for rollback.
13. *How prevent recomposition storms?* Distinct states, `@Immutable`, stable lambdas, keyed lists.

Concurrency

14. *Are state emissions ordered?* Yes — `StateFlow` serializes and conflates.
15. *Double-tap causing double submit?* Idempotent SSOT write, `mutating` flag, or debounce (Ch 9).
16. *Effect lost while backgrounded?* `Channel` buffers; collect lifecycle-aware (Ch 7).

Lifecycle

17. *Rotation — refetch?* No; `viewModelScope` + `WhileSubscribed` replay state.
18. *Process death?* `SavedStateHandle` (Ch 8).
19. *Why not hold state in the composable?* Lost on rotation/process death; untestable.

Events/effects

20. *Why not model navigation as a boolean state?* It re-fires on rotation (double navigation); use a one-time effect.
21. *`Channel` vs `SharedFlow` for effects?* Channel = exactly-once single consumer; SharedFlow = multiple/replay (Ch 7).

Scalability

22. *Complex transitions across many features?* MVI reducer + a shared base contract; unit-test transitions.
23. *Huge lists in state?* Paging (Ch 13), not one big `Content`.

Security

24. *Secrets in UI state?* No — in-memory/crash-logged/persisted; keep out.
25. *Is a nav effect authorization?* No; backend authorizes.

Performance

26. *Biggest recomposition pitfall?* Unstable types/lambdas and non-distinct state.
27. *How measure?* Layout Inspector recomposition counts; compiler stability report.

Testing

28. *How test a ViewModel?* `TestDispatcher` + fakes + Turbine on `uiState` / `effects`; no UI.
29. *Benefit of a pure reducer?* Transition tests without coroutines.
30. *How test effects fire once?* Assert a single emission on the effects flow.

Production debugging

31. *Snackbar reappears on rotation?* Effect stored as state; move to Channel.
32. *Screen blanks on rotation?* State owned by View, not ViewModel.
33. *Two screens disagree?* Not deriving from SSOT.

Trade-offs

34. *LiveData vs StateFlow?* StateFlow default; LiveData legacy.
35. *Sealed vs data-class state?* Mode-exclusive vs coexisting parts.
36. *When skip MVI?* Simple/static screens.

Deeper

37. *How combine several data sources into one state?* `combine(...)` then `stateIn`.
38. *How model partial/optimistic updates?* `mutating` flag / optimistic value + rollback (Ch 72).
39. *How keep `onEvent` stable for Compose?* Method reference `viewModel::onEvent`.
40. *How do effects survive config change but not double-fire?* Buffered `Channel`
    - lifecycle-aware single collection (Ch 7).

Design-change challenges

1. **Add optimistic likes/quantities.** Optimistic state + rollback on failure (Ch 72).
2. **Screen must survive process death with a draft.** `SavedStateHandle` (Ch 8).
3. **Transitions got complex (wizard).** Introduce an MVI reducer; unit-test it.
4. **Combine cart + promo + shipping into one screen.** `combine` flows → one state.
5. **Standardize across 20 feature teams.** A UDF base contract + testing harness
    - lint.

Mock walkthrough (abridged)

Clarify (async? modes? one-time effects?) → model `UiState` (sealed) making illegal states impossible → ViewModel owns `StateFlow` + `onEvent` + effects `Channel` → derive from SSOT → lifecycle-aware collection → failures/rollback → testing → defend MVVM+UDF vs MVI, StateFlow vs LiveData.

6.17 Practical Exercises

1. **Beginner.** Model a screen with a sealed `UiState` (Loading/Content/Empty/ Error) and render it with an exhaustive `when`. *Eval:* no booleans; compiler enforces all cases.
2. **Intermediate.** Add a one-time snackbar effect via `Channel`; prove it doesn't re-fire on rotation. *Eval:* single delivery; survives config change.
3. **Advanced.** Derive state from the SSOT (`Resource`) and add an optimistic quantity update with rollback. *Eval:* instant UI, correct rollback on failure.
4. **Production debugging.** Fix a screen that blanks on rotation (state in the composable) and whose snackbar repeats (effect as state). *Eval:* state in VM; effect via Channel.
5. **System design challenge.** Refactor a complex multi-step screen to an MVI reducer with unit-tested transitions. *Eval:* pure reducer; full transition coverage.

(Solutions withheld unless requested.)

6.18 Chapter Summary & Reference Sheet

Key decisions: one immutable `UiState` per screen owned by the ViewModel; UDF (state down, events up); model mutually-exclusive modes as a sealed hierarchy so illegal states are unrepresentable; one-time effects via `Channel` (Ch 7), never as state; derive state from the SSOT; collect lifecycle-aware; `stateIn(WhileSubscribed)`.

Concepts: UDF, single source of UI truth, illegal-states-unrepresentable, state vs effect, conflation, `WhileSubscribed`, reducer/MVI.

Common mistakes: scattered boolean flags; View-owned state (rotation loss); one-time events as state (double snackbar/nav); `collectAsState` without lifecycle; non-distinct/unstable state (recomposition storms); secrets in state.

Checklist:

- [ ] single `UiState`
- [ ] sealed where mode-exclusive
- [ ] `onEvent` entry point
- [ ] effects via `Channel`
- [ ] derive from SSOT
- [ ] `collectAsStateWithLifecycle`
- [ ] `stateIn(WhileSubscribed)`
- [ ] immutable/ `@Stable` state
- [ ] VM unit-tested
- [ ] no secrets in state.

Key APIs: `StateFlow`, `MutableStateFlow`, `stateIn`, `SharingStarted.WhileSubscribed`, `collectAsStateWithLifecycle`, `Channel` / `receiveAsFlow`, `flowWithLifecycle`, `combine`, `copy`, `@Immutable` / `@Stable`, Turbine.

References:

- UI layer / UDF: https://developer.android.com/topic/architecture/ui-layer
- UI events: https://developer.android.com/topic/architecture/ui-layer/events
- StateFlow/SharedFlow: https://developer.android.com/kotlin/flow/stateflow-and-sharedflow
- State in Compose: https://developer.android.com/develop/ui/compose/state
- `collectAsStateWithLifecycle`: https://developer.android.com/topic/libraries/architecture/compose

Chapter review (Phase 4)

- **Completeness:** all 18 sections; architecture/class/sequence/failure diagrams; state/event/effect model + ViewModel + Compose + reducer; concurrency; failure/ rollback; 5 levels; MVVM-vs-MVI trade-offs; security; perf/recomposition; VM + reducer tests; observability; 40 Q&A + 5 challenges. ✅
- **Expand later:** one-time events deep dive (Ch 7), process-death (Ch 8), optimistic updates (Ch 72), Molecule/compose-state.
- **Shared conventions introduced:** `UiState` / `UiEvent` / `Effect` naming, UDF loop, `stateIn(WhileSubscribed)` — followed by every feature chapter.